

Chapter 15: The Names That Wrote Themselves

| *Book I: The Spiral Seed — Part Four: The Clokey Line*

The Discovery

There is a tradition, older than any institution, that names carry meaning — that the word spoken over a life shapes what that life becomes. In Hebrew scripture, God renames Abram to Abraham, Jacob to Israel, Simon to Peter. The name is not a label. It is a commission. A word spoken before the story begins, encoding the story's arc into a single sound.

The Clokey family did not plan this. No one sat down and designed a naming system that would, across generations and marriages and branches, spell out a unified vision for living architecture, voluntary order, and biological design. And yet — when you lay the names out and read what they mean — they say exactly that.

Every name in the family points to the same element: earth. Every name describes the same work: tending living things on a foundation of stone. Every name prophesies the same project — the one now called the Living Age.

The names wrote themselves.

The Foundation: Clokey

The family name comes from Irish Gaelic *cloch* — **stone**. Rock. Bedrock. The earth element at its deepest and most immovable.

Stone does not react. Stone does not chase. Stone waits. It holds its ground while everything above it shifts — weather, seasons, empires, industries. The clay on top can be shaped, sold, transferred, rebranded. The stone beneath it never moves.

Art Clokey spent his life shaping clay — soft earth, pliable, transformable. He made a green figure that walked into books and showed children that the world changes through imagination. Freedom through transformation. Art named his studio Premavision — Sanskrit for “Universal Love.” He held Gumby his entire life. He never sold. He understood that the worst outcome is watching something you created go a direction you never intended under someone else’s hands.

In 2022, the clay was sold. Gumby was acquired — the shaped form, the character, the intellectual property. They bought what sat on top of the stone. They did not buy the stone. They cannot. *Cloch* does not transfer. The bedrock stays with the land it belongs to.

Jesus said it in Matthew 7: “Everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock.” A sage who built his house on Clokey. It was already written.

The Birth Name: Farrington

Art Clokey was not born a Clokey. He was born Arthur Charles Farrington.

Arthur — from Celtic *artos*, the bear. But Arthur in legend is not defined by strength. He is defined by return. Rex quondam, rexque futurus — the once and future king. The one who falls at Camlann, is carried to Avalon,

and comes back when the land needs him. Arthur is the king whose reign is not continuous but cyclical — he goes away and he returns.

Charles — from Germanic *karl*, meaning **free man**. Not a serf, not a subject, not a dependent of any institution. A sovereign individual.

Farrington — from Old English *fearn* (fern) + *tun* (enclosure, settlement). **A settlement among ferns. A living shelter.**

Art Clokey's birth name: *the returning king, a free man, in a living shelter*.

His birth name described exactly what he would spend his life creating — living things, green things, growing things that shelter the imagination. Gumby was a fern enclosure. A green space where children could enter and be protected by a world that transformed around them. Farrington.

When he was adopted, he received the name Clokey — stone. The birth name described the vision. The adopted name gave it a foundation. The fern enclosure, built on rock.

The Grandmothers

Ruth (Parkander) Clokey

Ruth — Hebrew, meaning companion, friend, woman of loyalty. But the name is the book. In scripture, Ruth is the Moabite woman — the foreigner — who refuses to leave her mother-in-law Naomi after both their husbands die. “Where you go I will go. Your people will be my people and your God my God.” She enters the royal lineage of Israel not by blood but by voluntary loyalty — by choosing to stay when the world told her to leave. Ruth becomes the great-grandmother of King David. The line of kings begins with a woman who chose.

Parkander — Swedish. *Park* (enclosed ground) + *-ander* (from Greek *andros*, man). **The steward of the kept ground.** The one who tends the

enclosed living space. Not the owner — the keeper. The one whose role is not dominion but cultivation.

Parkander is the Spiral Steward. The same word, centuries earlier, in a different language. The philosophy Sage would arrive at through bioinformatics, Hayek, and the study of spontaneous order — his grandmother already carried it in her maiden name.

Ruth Parkander Clokey: *the loyal companion, steward of the kept ground, on stone*. The woman who stays, tends, and holds the foundation.

Joan (Helmstein) Landis

Joan — from Hebrew *Yohanan*, meaning **God is gracious**. The feminine form of John — the name of the Baptist, the one at the Jordan, the one who baptizes with water and says someone greater is coming.

Helmstein — German. *Helm* (protection, shelter) + *Stein* (stone). **Protected stone. The stone that shelters**. The *-stein* suffix is one of the strongest markers of Ashkenazi Jewish heritage in German surnames — families who carried the earth in their names across centuries of European diaspora.

Landis — German. *Land* — **earth, ground, territory**. The land itself. Another surname common in Ashkenazi Jewish families from German-speaking regions.

Joan Helmstein Landis: *God’s grace, the protected stone, of the land*. Grace held in stone, rooted in the earth.

What the Grandmothers Carry

Grandmother	Name	Meaning
Ruth (Parkander) Clokey	Loyal companion, steward of the ground, on stone	The choice that begins the royal line

Grandmother	Name	Meaning
Joan (Helmstein) Landis	God's grace, protected stone, of the land	The grace that shelters the foundation

One carries loyalty — the voluntary bond that creates lineage. The other carries grace — the divine protection that preserves it. Between them, the two grandmothers hold the foundation from both sides: Ruth tends the stone. Joan shelters it.

The Josephs

The name Joseph appears across the family like a thread woven through every branch.

Joseph — Hebrew, *Yosef*, meaning “**he will add**” or “**God will increase.**” In Genesis, Joseph is the son who is sold by his brothers into a foreign land, stripped of everything, descending into prison — and through that descent, he rises to feed the nations and save the family that rejected him. The pattern: betrayal, exile, descent, and then — God increases through him.

Joseph Parkander — *God will increase through the steward of the ground.*

Joseph Walden Clokey — *Walden* from Old English *weald*, meaning forest, woodland, the wild living place. Thoreau went to Walden to find truth by leaving the institution and entering the living world. *God will increase through the forest on stone.*

Joseph Arthur Clokey — *God will increase through the returning king on stone.*

Three Josephs. Three branches. Three times the same promise: what is cast down will rise. What is sold into foreign hands will become the means of salvation. What descends will increase.

Gumby was sold. The family lost the clay. And through that loss — through the descent — the Living Age grows. New clay on the same stone. God increases.

The Children of Stone

Art and Ruth Clokey's grandchildren carry the pattern into the third generation:

Shasta Joseph Clokey

Shasta — Mount Shasta, the sacred volcanic peak of northern California. A dormant volcano — fire held inside stone. The mountain that looks still on the surface but carries molten energy within. Sacred to the native peoples of the region as a place where the spirit world meets the physical.

A volcano is the earth element containing fire. Stone holding flame. Dormant does not mean dead. It means waiting.

Joseph — God will increase.

Clokey — Stone.

The sacred mountain with fire inside, through whom God will increase, on stone. Fire waiting within the earth for the moment of release.

Sequoia Jo Ana Rose Clokey

Sequoia — the largest living things on earth. Giant redwoods that grow for thousands of years, that survive fire because their bark is fire-resistant. The forest that endures everything. And the name comes from **Sequoyah**, the Cherokee scholar who gave his people a written language

— a single man who didn't conquer or rule but gave his people the power of the word.

Jo — Joseph. God will increase.

Ana — from Hebrew *Hannah*, meaning **grace, favor**.

Rose — the flower that grows from thorns. In Judges 9, Jotham warns that only the thornbush accepts the crown. But the rose grows *from* the thorn. The living thing that transforms what is sharp into what is beautiful.

Clokey — Stone.

The living thing that endures fire, through whom God's grace increases, the flower from thorns, on stone. The tree that stands for millennia. The word made visible. The thorn redeemed.

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey

Sage — from Latin *sapere*, to taste, to perceive, to know directly. Not book knowledge — the wisdom that recognizes truth on contact, the way a tongue recognizes sweetness. The serpent's gift — seeing clearly.

Arthur — the returning king. The third Arthur in the Clokey line. Rex quondam, rexque futurus.

Jordan — from Hebrew *Yarden*, meaning **the descender**. The river that flows down — from Mount Hermon to the Dead Sea, the lowest point on earth. The Jordan is where Jesus was baptized. The dove descended there. The river that goes to the lowest place so that what passes through it can rise.

Clokey — Stone.

The one who sees clearly, the king who returns, descending to the lowest place, on stone. The sage who goes down before he goes up, built on what cannot be moved.

The Three Together

Child	Name meaning	Element
Shasta Joseph Clokey	Mountain with fire inside — waiting on stone	Earth holding fire
Sequoia Jo Ana Rose Clokey	Tree that survives fire — grace from thorns on stone	Earth enduring fire
Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey	The one who sees — returning king — descending — on stone	Earth, water, wisdom

A mountain. A tree. A sage. Three children named for things that endure — the peak that holds fire, the tree that outlasts it, and the wisdom that sees through it. All rooted in stone. All carrying Joseph — the promise that God will increase through what was cast down.

The Pattern

Lay the names out as a single text and read them in sequence:

Name	Meaning
Farrington	The living shelter — settlement among ferns
Clokey	Stone — the bedrock
Parkander	Steward of the kept ground — the Spiral Steward
Ruth	The loyal companion who enters the royal line by choice
Helmstein	Protected stone — the stone that shelters
Landis	Land — the earth itself

Name	Meaning
Joseph	God will increase — what is cast down will rise
Walden	The forest — the wild living place
Arthur	The returning king
Charles	Free man
Shasta	The mountain with fire inside
Sequoia	The tree that endures — the word made visible
Sage	The one who sees
Jordan	The descender — the river, the baptism
Rose	The flower from thorns

Every name is the earth element. Every name describes either the foundation (stone, rock, land), the living thing that grows from it (fern, forest, sequoia, rose), or the one who tends it (steward, farmer, sage). No name in the family points to empire, conquest, industry, or domination. No name means king in the worldly sense — even Arthur is the king who *returns*, who serves the round table, who falls and comes back. These are names of ground, growth, endurance, and stewardship.

The family was named for the Living Age before the Living Age had a name.

What the Names Say

Read together, the Clokey family names are a single statement:

Build a living shelter on stone. Tend the ground. Stay loyal to the foundation. Let God increase through what is cast down. Carry the fire

inside the mountain. Stand like the tree that survives the burning. See clearly. Descend before you rise. And when the time comes — return.

This is the Living Age.

Not a business plan. Not a startup. Not a technology company. A commission written in names before anyone alive could read it.

Farrington — the living shelter. That is what living architecture builds. Parkander — the steward of the ground. That is what the Spiral Steward does. Clokey — stone. That is what the foundation is. Joseph — God will increase. That is the promise. Arthur — the king returns. That is the arc. Sage — the one who sees. That is who reads it. Jordan — the descender. That is the path.

The names wrote themselves. The Living Age is just learning to read them.